

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Financial Advice English



Teacher's guide

Teach practical workplace communication with specific cases, clear language targets, and a repeatable feedback process.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For financial advisors, planners, wealth-management teams, retirement specialists, paraplanners, and client-service staff.

Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Advisor English: Discovery, Scope, Trust, and Boundaries

Clarify missing information before responding.

02 Standards of Conduct, Best Interest, Disclosures, and Conflicts

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

03 Goals, Risk Profile, Asset Allocation, and IPS Language

Clarify missing information before responding.

04 Retirement Planning, Income, Tax-Aware Conversations, and RMDs

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

05 Portfolio Reviews, Volatility, Rebalancing, and Behavioral Coaching

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

06 Products, Account Types, Rollovers, Annuities, Insurance, and Alternatives

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

07 Family, Estate, Beneficiaries, Elder Risk, and Difficult Client Moments

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

08 Practice Management, Documentation, Complaints, Marketing, and Supervision

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop, or use the prompts at the end of this guide.

A 60-minute lesson that works

Prepare the case and the learner pages. Keep the model response hidden until learners have attempted their own. Choose two field terms that are important to understanding the case.

0-5 minutes | Activate experience

Ask learners to name a comparable situation without sharing confidential details. Introduce the communication goal.

5-12 minutes | Read and sort facts

Read the case. Learners identify confirmed facts, unknowns, the audience, and the immediate communication need.

12-22 minutes | Notice and practice language

Explain the workshop pattern. Work through the vocabulary and editing example, then discuss both language checks and the reasons behind the choices.

22-35 minutes | 05 • Conversations

Read one ten-turn conversation aloud, notice a useful expression, then compare the other two. Identify each speaker's purpose and how the exchange ends.

35-47 minutes | 06 • Say it

Rehearse both speaking scenarios from the workbook. Give two minutes of preparation, switch roles, and use the success checks. Add the complication only after a successful first round.

47-55 minutes | Compare and revise

Reveal the model. Discuss alternative acceptable wording. Give one meaning correction and one language correction, then repeat.

55-60 minutes | Retrieve and transfer

Close the materials. Learners recall two expressions and identify one communication habit to use in another situation.

Adapt the session

For 45 minutes, study one complete conversation and rehearse one scenario; assign the others for oral follow-up. For 90 minutes, rehearse all three conversations and give both scenarios a second round. More time should produce more meaningful practice, not longer explanations.

LESSON 01 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Advisor English: Discovery, Scope, Trust, and Boundaries

Clarify missing information before responding.

CASE

A prospective client says, "I want to retire comfortably." No spending estimate, target date, or current asset summary is available.

Teach this move

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

Vocabulary to check: Client objective, Investment objective, Financial plan, Time horizon.

Model response

What would a comfortable retirement look like for you? Could we start with your target date and expected spending? That will help us understand your goals before discussing possible approaches.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: "what this means".

Second-round challenge

The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Language-check answers

1. B - Could you confirm when the review starts? The embedded question uses subject then verb: "the review starts".
2. A - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review? This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

05 • Conversations

1. What would comfortable retirement include? - The lesson's prospective client has no supplied spending estimate, target retirement date, or asset summary. This is discovery-language practice, not financial advice.

2. A business sale is only a possible resource - Separate fictional discovery exercise: a business owner wants to reduce working hours in three years and may sell the business; no sale valuation is available.

3. An education goal without a payment schedule - Separate fictional discovery exercise: a consultant wants to help fund a relative's education in five years, but the amount and payment pattern are unknown.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | One household, two meanings of security

In a fictional discovery call, one partner means predictable monthly spending by financial security; the other means being able to change jobs. No budget or target date is supplied.

Role A: You are the financial planner. Invite both meanings and clarify what remains unknown.

Role B: You represent the household. Explain the two goals without pretending they already have a shared priority.

Possible opening: Could we separate predictable spending from flexibility to change jobs before setting one combined objective?

Success checks

- Recognize both stated goals.
- Keep spending amounts and timing unknown.
- Agree a further discovery question rather than choose a product or impose a priority.

Add a complication: One partner asks you to choose the household's priority for them.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 02 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Standards of Conduct, Best Interest, Disclosures, and Conflicts

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

CASE

A client asks how a firm is paid. The adviser has the firm's current fee and relationship disclosures available.

Teach this move

Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

Vocabulary to check: Disclosure, Conflict of interest, Form CRS, Form ADV.

Model response

Let's walk through the current disclosures together, including fees, services, and relevant conflicts. Which parts would you like me to explain? I can also show where the information is recorded.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revised sentence names the action in familiar words. Specialist vocabulary is useful when it adds precision, but repeating abstract nouns can hide the meaning.

Second-round challenge

Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Language-check answers

1. A - The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed. This gives the meaning in familiar words.
2. C - How would you describe the next step in your own words? An open request lets the listener show their understanding.

05 • Conversations

1. Explaining the firm's compensation disclosure - Separate fictional training firm: the supplied disclosure states a \$900 annual planning fee paid by the client, no referral payments or commissions, and separately charged third-party product costs whose amounts are not supplied.

2. A fixed planning fee and a separate product cost - Separate fictional training firm: its sample disclosure lists a \$600 one-time planning fee and says third-party product costs are separate and not quoted here.
3. A referral payment needs its own explanation - Separate fictional practice example: a sample disclosure states the firm receives a referral payment from one external provider; no amount is supplied.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | Service scope is not a conduct guarantee

A fictional firm's service summary lists quarterly review meetings. A prospective client interprets that schedule as proof that every recommendation will be suitable for them. No recommendation has been made.

Role A: You explain the service. Distinguish meeting frequency from the assessment of an individual recommendation.

Role B: You are the prospective client. Ask what information and disclosures would support that assessment.

Possible opening: Quarterly meetings describe the service schedule; they don't by themselves establish the appropriateness of a recommendation.

Success checks

- Explain the service-versus-assessment distinction.
- Avoid promising outcomes or asserting an unreviewed conduct standard.
- Agree to review the actual scope and relevant disclosures.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to call the meeting schedule a guarantee of best outcomes.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 03 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Goals, Risk Profile, Asset Allocation, and IPS Language

Clarify missing information before responding.

CASE

A client describes themselves as comfortable with investment risk but says they need some funds for a house purchase next year.

Teach this move

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

Vocabulary to check: Risk tolerance, Risk capacity, Liquidity need, IPS.

Model response

When you say you're comfortable with risk, are you including the money needed next year? Let's distinguish your willingness to accept losses from your ability to absorb them for each goal.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: "what this means".

Second-round challenge

The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Language-check answers

1. C - Could you confirm when the review starts? The embedded question uses subject then verb: "the review starts".
2. B - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review? This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

05 • Conversations

1. Risk comfort and next year's house funds - The lesson's client feels comfortable with investment risk but needs some funds for a house purchase next year; the amount is unknown.

2. A questionnaire conflicts with a withdrawal need - Separate fictional review: a client selected 'no planned withdrawals' on a questionnaire but mentions an expected business payment in six months; the amount is unconfirmed.

3. A loss threshold needs a meaning check - Separate fictional planning conversation: a client says they can tolerate a 10% loss, but has not specified the account, time period, or whether that means temporary fluctuation.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | Two accounts with different purposes

A fictional client has one account earmarked for an expense in eighteen months and another described as long-term savings. Amounts and investment holdings are not supplied.

Role A: You are the adviser. Ask how fixed the expense is and distinguish the accounts' purposes.

Role B: You are the client. Explain that one general risk label may not describe both accounts.

Possible opening: Could we assess the eighteen-month expense separately from the savings with a longer horizon?

Success checks

- Identify the two different horizons.
- Ask about the fixed or flexible nature of the expense.
- Avoid choosing allocations from incomplete facts.

Add a complication: The client asks you to assign the same allocation to both before discussing amounts.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 04 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Retirement Planning, Income, Tax-Aware Conversations, and RMDs

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

CASE

A retirement illustration assumes a fixed annual return. A client reads the chart as a promise of future income.

Teach this move

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

Vocabulary to check: Retirement income, Withdrawal rate, Sequence risk, Monte Carlo analysis.

Model response

This is an illustration based on assumptions, not a guaranteed income path. Let's review how different returns and spending needs change the picture before discussing any planning decision.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Second-round challenge

Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Language-check answers

1. B - The change may have contributed to the delay. 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.
2. A - In this pilot, the observed result was ... This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

05 • Conversations

1. The smooth retirement line is not a promise - The lesson's illustration assumes a fixed annual return, and the client reads the result as promised income.

2. A simulation percentage needs a definition - Separate fictional retirement exercise: a Monte Carlo output labels 80% of modeled paths successful under specified assumptions; success criteria have not been explained to the client.

3. A distribution question needs current individual review - Separate fictional planning call: a client asks whether a retirement-account distribution is required; account type, age, and current applicable rules have not been checked.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | Inflation is absent from the headline

A fictional retirement illustration shows level annual spending in nominal dollars. The headline calls the spending power constant, but no inflation adjustment is included.

Role A: You are the planner. Explain the difference between unchanged dollar spending and unchanged purchasing power.

Role B: You are the client. Ask which assumption the illustration makes without supplying an inflation forecast.

Possible opening: The dollar amount stays level here, but that does not establish constant purchasing power.

Success checks

- Distinguish nominal dollars from purchasing power.
- Identify the missing inflation treatment.
- Agree to label and review assumptions rather than promise future spending power.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to insert an inflation number without labeling it as an assumption.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 05 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Portfolio Reviews, Volatility, Rebalancing, and Behavioral Coaching

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

CASE

A client's statement shows a decline, and they want to know whether the change reflects withdrawals, fees, or market movement.

Teach this move

Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

Vocabulary to check: Benchmark, Drawdown, Rebalancing, Asset allocation.

Model response

Let's separate the withdrawals, fees, and investment movement for the same period. That will explain the balance change more clearly than looking only at the opening and closing totals.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revised sentence names the action in familiar words. Specialist vocabulary is useful when it adds precision, but repeating abstract nouns can hide the meaning.

Second-round challenge

Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Language-check answers

1. A - The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed. This gives the meaning in familiar words.
2. C - How would you describe the next step in your own words? An open request lets the listener show their understanding.

05 • Conversations

1. A lower balance has several possible components - The lesson's client sees a statement decline and asks whether withdrawals, fees, or market movement explain it; amounts are not supplied.

2. Rebalancing is not restoring a previous balance - Separate fictional review: a portfolio's asset weights have drifted from its stated targets; the client thinks rebalancing guarantees recovery of a previous balance.

3. A drawdown and a period return use different starting points - Separate fictional training chart: an account value peaked before the reporting period began; the chart labels both drawdown and period return without explaining their bases.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A contribution makes the balance look stronger

A fictional account's balance rose during a month when the client added money. No investment-return calculation is supplied, and the client wants to compare the balance increase with a benchmark return.

Role A: You are the adviser. Explain the contribution-versus-performance distinction.

Role B: You are the client. Ask what comparable calculation is needed before claiming outperformance.

Possible opening: The contribution increased your balance, but it isn't itself an investment return.

Success checks

- Keep contributions visible.
- Do not invent the actual investment return.
- Agree a like-for-like performance comparison before interpreting success.

Add a complication: A colleague proposes excluding the contribution from the explanation because the result looks positive.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 06 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Products, Account Types, Rollovers, Annuities, Insurance, and Alternatives

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

CASE

A client is comparing two account options. One summary omits exit charges and ongoing service differences.

Teach this move

Use the same time period, scope, and measurement basis for both options. Explain a difference with 'whereas' or 'while'. State what improves and what is given up; do not hide the weaker side of a recommendation.

Vocabulary to check: Expense ratio, Surrender charge, Managed account, Annuity.

Model response

We need the same categories for both options: charges, services, restrictions, and relevant tax considerations. I'll use the current documents to build a comparable summary before we discuss suitability.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. 'Better' already has comparative meaning, so it does not need 'more'. Naming the criterion and tradeoff makes the comparison useful.

Second-round challenge

Your listener focuses only on the lowest price or fastest date. Explain one other relevant comparison criterion.

Language-check answers

1. C - Option A is faster, whereas option B costs less. 'Whereas' marks a contrast between two options.
2. B - An increase of one percentage point. Subtracting 6% from 7% gives one percentage point. The relative increase is about 16.7%.

05 • Conversations

1. Two accounts with incomplete exit-cost information - The lesson's account comparison omits exit charges and ongoing service differences from one summary; no product choice is authorized.

2. Lower annual cost or more frequent reviews? - Separate fictional comparison for one year: option A lists a \$500 annual service cost and one annual review; B lists \$800 and quarterly reviews. Review scope, product costs, exit charges, and individual suitability are unassessed.

3. A rollover comparison needs the existing account too - Separate fictional review: a proposed rollover account has a detailed service brochure, but the existing account's costs and features have not been gathered.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | Different service frequencies in a cost table

In a fictional comparison, option A includes an annual review and option B quarterly reviews. Their quoted costs cover the same year, but the review scope and other charges are unknown.

Role A: You explain the comparison. Identify the service-frequency difference and missing scope.

Role B: You are the client. Ask whether more meetings necessarily mean more useful service for your needs.

Possible opening: The costs cover the same year, but the review frequency differs and the review scope is still unclear.

Success checks

- Name annual versus quarterly frequency.
- Keep service quality, scope, and other charges unestablished.
- Agree to compare relevant services rather than rank by frequency alone.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to call quarterly reviews automatically superior.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 07 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Family, Estate, Beneficiaries, Elder Risk, and Difficult Client Moments

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

CASE

A client asks how to review beneficiary details after a family change. The service team can explain the firm's process but cannot resolve legal questions.

Teach this move

State the action and the information needed. Explain why it matters and specify a deadline only when one is given or agreed. 'Could you' is polite; repeated apologies can obscure a legitimate request. Urgent situations may require a direct request.

Vocabulary to check: Beneficiary designation, Refer, Document, Escalate.

Model response

We can help you review the beneficiary information held by the firm and explain the update process. For questions about legal effects or estate planning, let's identify the appropriate qualified adviser.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision names the document and requested response. It avoids expressions that may be unfamiliar or ambiguous for an international audience.

Second-round challenge

The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Language-check answers

1. B - Send it no later than Thursday. 'By' sets the latest point, while 'after' refers to a later time.
2. A - Could you confirm the document version needed for the review? The requested action and information are explicit.

05 • Conversations

1. Requesting a beneficiary review after a family change - The lesson's client wants to review beneficiary details. The service team can explain its process but cannot resolve legal questions.

2. A relative requests access to account details - Separate fictional service call: a client's adult relative asks for account information; their authorization has not been verified.

3. Escalating a concern without diagnosing incapacity - Separate fictional service exercise: a client repeats the same payment question during a call. The cause is unknown, and no change is authorized.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A beneficiary form received but not checked

A fictional client submitted a beneficiary form and asks whether the account now reflects it. The service team confirms receipt only; completeness and processing have not been checked.

Role A: You are the service specialist. Request the processing-status check and explain the current limit.

Role B: You are the client. Ask for confirmation of the actual record without assuming receipt equals completion.

Possible opening: We have received the form, but I need to confirm review and processing before describing the account as updated.

Success checks

- Separate receipt from completed processing.
- Request a precise account-status check.
- Refer legal-effect questions rather than invent an answer.

Add a complication: The client asks you to confirm the legal effect of the form before review.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 08 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Practice Management, Documentation, Complaints, Marketing, and Supervision

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

CASE

A client says a service email did not answer their complaint. The record shows an acknowledgment but no response to the specific concern.

Teach this move

Name what was unclear or wrong, acknowledge its effect, and correct it. A brief apology can help, followed by a practical next step. Avoid explaining away the other person's reaction or promising an outcome you cannot control.

Vocabulary to check: Disclosure, Document, Supervise, Update.

Model response

You're right that our earlier message did not address that concern. I'll record the issue accurately and confirm the next step in our complaints process, including when you should expect an update.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision takes responsibility for the message without blaming the listener. It identifies what needs to be corrected.

Second-round challenge

The listener remains disappointed after the correction. Acknowledge the impact and restate the available next step calmly.

Language-check answers

1. A - I'm sorry my earlier wording was unclear. This acknowledges the speaker's contribution to the problem.
2. C - The corrected date and the current confirmation status. A repair needs usable corrected information, including any uncertainty.

05 • Conversations

1. Acknowledgment did not answer the complaint - The lesson's complaint record contains an acknowledgment but no response to the client's specific concern.

2. A review meeting listed as completed by mistake - Separate fictional practice record: a client meeting was scheduled but did not occur; an internal status incorrectly marks the review completed.

3. A service promise exceeds the approved description - Separate fictional practice example: a draft client message promises monthly reviews, while the supplied service description lists quarterly reviews. The message is unsent.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A complaint category misses the issue

A fictional client complained about a delayed callback. The record categorizes it as a fee question, and no callback review has occurred. The client points out the mismatch.

Role A: You are the service manager. Acknowledge the misclassification and state the actual concern.

Role B: You are the client. Ask how the callback issue will receive review without accepting a premature resolution claim.

Possible opening: We recorded your callback concern as a fee question; that was inaccurate and needs correction.

Success checks

- Name and correct the category mismatch.
- Separate record correction from substantive review.
- Agree review ownership and an accurate next-status update.

Add a complication: A colleague suggests closing the complaint after changing its category.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

Investor.gov: investing glossary

<https://www.investor.gov/introduction-investing/investing-basics/glossary>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the next two prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Writing feedback begins with your draft. Vocabulary, grammar and review prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has eight practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

The two starter prompts use B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-28. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Adapt a partner or class activity

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Financial Advice English

Professional audience: financial advisors, planners, wealth-management teams, retirement specialists, paraplanners, and client-service staff

Scope: Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

Lesson 01: Advisor English: Discovery, Scope, Trust, and Boundaries

Original fictional case: A prospective client says, "I want to retire comfortably." No spending estimate, target date, or current asset summary is available.

Language workshop: Ask a precise question

Communication goal: Clarify missing information before responding.

Language guidance: Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): When you say ..., do you mean ...? / Could you clarify which ...? / So, my understanding is Is that right?

Vocabulary: Client objective: The goal the plan is designed to support, not necessarily the client's latest emotional reaction. / Investment objective: What the client is trying to accomplish, such as growth, income, preservation, or liquidity. / Financial plan: A coordinated view of goals, resources, assumptions, risks, and recommended actions. / Time horizon: How long the client expects to invest before needing funds for a goal.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Writing task: Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Optional second-round challenge: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: What would a comfortable retirement look like for you? Could we start with your target date and expected spending? That will help us understand your goals before discussing possible approaches.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Adapt this material for a teaching session

1. Ask me one brief planning question covering learner support needs, group size and available time. Offer a default of two B2 learners and 20 minutes. Stop and wait; use the default only if I choose it.
2. Create a timed plan using the supplied case or dialogue, its actual terminology and one narrow language goal. Include an individual first attempt, partner exchange, focused feedback and a retry. Keep the total within the time I choose. State what the learner should be able to communicate at the end.
3. Provide separate role cards for two or three professional speakers. Each card needs an objective, known information and one question to resolve. Label any invented private information as a variation; do not contradict shared facts. Do not place the model answer on the learner cards.
4. Add a B1 support option with useful frames, a B2 independent task and a C1 extension involving a plausible competing constraint. Maintain the same professional meaning across levels. Explain unfamiliar terms without removing the field's normal language. Include a workable solo alternative.
5. Put teacher notes and suggested responses in a clearly separate section after the learner material. Include likely misunderstandings and a short observation checklist for facts, clarity, tone and next step. Accept multiple successful formulations. Finish with one exit question and a delayed-recall task; identify what the teacher should check before use.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level

Adjust tone and register

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Financial Advice English

Professional audience: financial advisors, planners, wealth-management teams, retirement specialists, paraplanners, and client-service staff

Scope: Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

Lesson 01: Advisor English: Discovery, Scope, Trust, and Boundaries

Original fictional case: A prospective client says, "I want to retire comfortably." No spending estimate, target date, or current asset summary is available.

Language workshop: Ask a precise question

Communication goal: Clarify missing information before responding.

Language guidance: Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): When you say ..., do you mean ...? / Could you clarify which ...? / So, my understanding is Is that right?

Vocabulary: Client objective: The goal the plan is designed to support, not necessarily the client's latest emotional reaction. / Investment objective: What the client is trying to accomplish, such as growth, income, preservation, or liquidity. / Financial plan: A coordinated view of goals, resources, assumptions, risks, and recommended actions. / Time horizon: How long the client expects to invest before needing funds for a goal.

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Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Writing task: Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Optional second-round challenge: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: What would a comfortable retirement look like for you? Could we start with your target date and expected spending? That will help us understand your goals before discussing possible approaches.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Match the language to the listener

1. Choose a short message or utterance from the reference and quote it exactly. Identify its purpose and likely audience. Ask me to choose a new audience: a close colleague, a decision-maker, or an external reader who may not know the jargon. Stop and wait.
2. Ask me to adapt that message for the chosen reader, keeping its facts and degree of certainty unchanged. Offer a short frame only if I request help. Wait for my attempt before showing alternatives.
3. Discuss at most three choices in my version: directness, specialist vocabulary and interpersonal tone. Explain when a direct request is clearer than extra politeness, and when an unfamiliar abbreviation needs expansion. Avoid cultural stereotypes or claims that one nationality always communicates a certain way.
4. Show two natural alternatives, such as a concise spoken version and a more explicit written version. Explain the tradeoff in each. Do not turn a request into an order, a possibility into a promise, or a pending decision into approval.
5. Ask me to respond to one realistic follow-up from the new reader, then wait. Finish by asking me to adapt the message for a second audience without losing its core meaning. Give feedback only after the attempt.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level